
HALIGRIC CEREMONIES AND RITUALS INDEX

All Sacred Ceremonies from the Deep Dive Library — Alphabetical by Culture

This is a living index —
a reference tool for practitioners
who want to find the ceremony
that belongs to the tradition they are studying.
Each entry names the ceremony,
describes its sacred purpose,
and notes where to find it in the library.
The full step-by-step instructions
live in the source document.
This is the map.
The deep dive PDFs are the territory.

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AKAN (Ghana / Ivory Coast)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Akwasidae / Awukudae	Ancestor veneration ceremony at the stool house; pouring libation and feeding the ancestral stools of deceased chiefs and matriarchs. Conducted every six weeks on the Akan calendar.	Akan Tradition Deep Dive
Odwira	Annual harvest purification and thanksgiving — cleansing the community of the previous year's accumulated miasma (spiritual pollution). The most important annual Akan ceremony.	Akan Tradition Deep Dive
Ohum	River festival honoring the Abosom of major rivers — communal purification through ceremonial bathing and river offering.	Akan Tradition Deep Dive
Libation (Akan form)	Pouring water or schnapps while calling the names of specific ancestors and divine beings, acknowledging their continued presence and requesting their participation.	Akan Tradition Deep Dive

AINU (Northern Japan / Hokkaido)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Iyomante (Bear Sending)	The most important Ainu ceremony — the community raises a bear cub for 2–3 years, then ritually releases its spirit back to the kamuy realm as a divine messenger. The bear returns as an honored guest, not a sacrifice.	Ainu Japan Deep Dive
Kamuy Nomi	General sacred ceremony — offerings to specific kamuy, fire prayers through Ape Huc (Fire Grandmother), sacred willow inau (prayer sticks).	Ainu Japan Deep Dive
Tusu Ceremony	The Ainu shaman enters trance to communicate with the kamuy world, diagnose illness, and conduct healing on behalf of the community.	Ainu Japan Deep Dive
Yukar Performance	Sacred epic song cycles performed by specialists (traditionally women) in ceremonial context — the tradition's primary vehicle for transmitting sacred knowledge across generations.	Ainu Japan Deep Dive

AZTEC / MEXICA

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
New Fire Ceremony (Xiuhmolpilli)	Every 52 years when the Calendar Round completes — all fires extinguished, the new fire kindled at the Hill of the Star. If the fire catches, the world continues. Cosmic renewal at the largest scale.	Aztec/Mexica Deep Dive
Toxcatl (Month 5 Festival)	A living man selected as the living image (ixiptla) of Tezcatlipoca for one year, then sacrificed. The most complete embodiment of divine presence in human form in Aztec practice.	Aztec/Mexica Deep Dive
Tlacaxipehualiztli (Month 2)	Festival of Xipe Totec — the Flayed God. Sacred renewal through the wearing of the flayed skin of a sacrificed person, representing the earth shedding its outer layer to reveal new growth.	Serpent & Star / Aztec Deep Dive
Panquetzaliztli (Month 15)	The great festival of Huitzilopochtli — the most elaborate ceremony honoring the sun god and patron deity of the Mexica.	Aztec/Mexica Deep Dive

BALINESE

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Nyepi (Day of Silence)	Balinese New Year — 24 hours of complete silence, darkness, fasting, and stillness across the entire island. No fires, no travel, no work, no noise. The demons of the old year, finding nothing to attach to, move on.	Balinese Beliefs Deep Dive
Galungan / Kuningan	The two most important Balinese festivals — occurring every 210 days. Galungan celebrates the victory of Dharma over Adharma. Kuningan, 10 days later, marks the ancestors' return to their realm.	Balinese Beliefs Deep Dive
Melasti Purification	Communal purification ceremony before Nyepi — sacred objects are carried to the sea for purification. The sea receives the spiritual accumulation of the previous year.	Balinese Beliefs Deep Dive
Kajeng Kliwon	A particularly charged day (occurring every 15 days in the Pawukon calendar) requiring intensified offerings and protective ceremony. The intersection of the 3-day and 5-day weeks in the Balinese calendar.	Balinese Beliefs Deep Dive

BASQUE

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Akelarre	The sacred gathering of the sorginak (sacred specialists) — conducted at specific outdoor locations at seasonal turning points. The word "witches' sabbath" was imposed on this practice by the Inquisition.	Basque Sacred Traditions Deep Dive
Etxe Ancestor Ceremony	Ceremony at the sacred house (etxe) honoring the ancestors — the household fire acknowledged as their presence, the hearth as sacred center.	Basque Sacred Traditions Deep Dive
Cromlech Ceremony	Ceremony at the Basque sacred stone circle sites — honoring Mari and the pre-Indo-European sacred landscape of the Basque homeland.	Basque Sacred Traditions Deep Dive

BLACKFOOT CONFEDERACY (Siksika, Kainai, Piikani)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Okan (Sun Dance)	The most important Blackfoot ceremony — a multi-day ceremony of prayer, fasting, and sacred dance honoring the Sun. Conducted each summer, pledged by a sacred woman (Medicine Woman) in fulfillment of a vow.	Blackfoot Confederacy Deep Dive
Sweat Lodge (Okan preparation)	Purification ceremony conducted before the Sun Dance and as regular sacred practice. The lodge as the body of the Earth Mother; the steam as her breath.	Blackfoot Confederacy Deep Dive
Bundle Opening Ceremony	Opening of sacred medicine bundles at specific seasonal times — each bundle a living repository of relationship between the people and specific spirit powers.	Blackfoot Confederacy Deep Dive

BUDDHISM (Tibetan / Vajrayana)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Sadhana (Deity Visualization)	The core Vajrayana practice — refuge/bodhicitta, emptiness meditation, seed syllable arising, deity form generation, mantra recitation, dissolution back into emptiness. The full daily structure of Vajrayana practice.	Tibetan Buddhism & Bon Deep Dive

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Mandala Offering	The offering of the entire universe (visualized as a jeweled mandala) as an act of non-attachment and accumulation of merit. One of the Tibetan preliminary practices (ngöndro).	Tibetan Buddhism & Bon Deep Dive
Prayer Flag Ceremony	Hanging specific colored prayer flags in wind — each color corresponding to an element, the wind carrying the prayers outward in all directions.	Tibetan Buddhism & Bon Deep Dive
Prostrations (Full Body)	108 full prostrations as purification practice — the body, speech, and mind simultaneously engaged in homage. A core ngöndro preliminary practice.	Tibetan Buddhism & Bon Deep Dive
Reading the Bardo Thodol	Reading aloud to the dying or recently deceased to guide consciousness through the six bardos — the Tibetan Book of the Dead as active ceremonial technology, not merely literature.	Tibetan Buddhism & Bon Deep Dive

BON (Pre-Buddhist Tibet)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Propitiation of Local Deities	Shen priest ceremony: divination to identify offended deity, offerings prepared, deity invoked in Bon sacred language. Maintaining the relationship between the human community and the spirit landscape.	Tibetan Buddhism & Bon Deep Dive
Soul Retrieval (Bdag 'Gug)	Bon soul retrieval ceremony — specific visualization, mantras, sacred objects, and the shen's spirit-world capacity used to locate and return a lost soul fragment to its owner.	Tibetan Buddhism & Bon Deep Dive

CADDO CONFEDERACY (Texas / Oklahoma / Louisiana)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Black Drink Ceremony	Purification before councils and ceremony — yaupon holly leaves brewed into a strong tea, consumed communally to induce ritual purification and clarity.	Caddo Confederacy Deep Dive
Morning Star Ceremony	Timed to Venus's astronomical appearance — night vigil, the sacred fire through darkness, the Xinesi's prayers at the rise of Venus.	Caddo Confederacy Deep Dive

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
First Fruits Ceremony	Harvest ceremony — the tapu on new corn, offering to sacred fire and Xinesi, first eating releasing the tapu, communal celebration.	Caddo Confederacy Deep Dive

CANAANITE

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Marzeh Banquet	The sacred feast — a ceremonial meal in honor of specific deities, combining communal eating, sacred wine, and the presence of the divine at the table.	Canaanite Religion Deep Dive
First Fruits Ceremony	Offering of the first harvest before any household may eat from the new crop. The relationship between the human community and the divine as one of mutual acknowledgment.	Canaanite Religion Deep Dive
Hieros Gamos (Sacred Marriage)	The sacred marriage of the king with the goddess — the specific ritual through which political authority was anchored in the divine feminine.	Canaanite Religion Deep Dive

CHEROKEE

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Green Corn Ceremony	The most important Cherokee ceremony — annual renewal, purification, and thanksgiving for the corn harvest. Old fires extinguished, new sacred fire lit, debts forgiven, community restored.	Cherokee Beliefs Deep Dive
Booger Dance	Sacred ceremony involving masked performers representing foreign and threatening forces — a ceremony of naming the threat, facing it communally, and dissolving its power through sacred performance.	Cherokee Beliefs Deep Dive
Going to Water	Ritual immersion in running water at dawn — a purification practice conducted at key ceremonial transitions and as regular sacred maintenance.	Cherokee Beliefs Deep Dive

CHINESE (Folk Religion / Taoism / Wu Shamanism)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Chinese New Year Ceremony	15-day ritual renewal at the start of the lunar year — firecrackers, door god images renewed, red envelopes, the Kitchen God sent to heaven with sweet offerings, reunion feast on New Year's Eve.	Chinese Folk Religion Deep Dive
Qingming (Grave Tending)	Early April — families visit graves, make offerings, burn paper money to send resources to ancestors. The primary annual ancestor honoring ceremony in Chinese tradition.	Chinese Folk Religion Deep Dive
Ghost Festival (Zhongyuan Jie)	15th day of 7th lunar month — honoring the forgotten dead who have no one left to remember them. The floating date in the Haligric Calendar.	Chinese Folk Religion Deep Dive
Wu Shamanic Journey	The Wu shaman's trance journey between the three cosmic realms — ascending to the sky realm or descending to the underworld to retrieve information or healing on behalf of a petitioner.	Wu Chinese Shamanism Deep Dive
Kitchen God Ceremony	Annual ceremony before the Kitchen God's departure to heaven — sweet offerings placed at his image so he reports only sweet things about the household. A ceremony of sacred diplomacy.	Chinese Folk Religion Deep Dive
Sexagenary Cycle Observance (Ganzhi)	The 60-year cycle of Heavenly Stems and Earthly Branches — the foundational Chinese sacred time system underlying the Chinese zodiac and the five-element calendar. Practitioners track their position in the 60-year cycle as a sacred temporal orientation practice.	Chinese Folk Religion Deep Dive

DRUIDIC / CELTIC

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Wheel of the Year — All Eight	See the Haligric Calendar section. The eight sacred turning points: Samhain, Yule, Imbolc, Ostara, Beltane, Litha, Lammas/Lughnasadh, Mabon. The ceremony of living in alignment with the turning of light and dark.	The Druids Deep Dive; Haligric Rituals Book
Sacred Well Ceremony	Visiting a specific sacred spring (holy well) with prayer, specific offerings, and the sacred water's healing application — clootie strips tied on trees, wishes spoken to the water, the specific protocol of each well honored.	The Druids Deep Dive; Irish Heritage Deep Dive; Welsh Sacred Traditions Deep Dive

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Tigh Allais (Irish Sweat House)	The Irish sweat house ceremony — almost identical in structure to the Native American sweat lodge. Entry in a specific order, the hot stones honored, steam raised, prayers spoken, emergence as rebirth.	Irish Heritage Deep Dive
Awen Invocation	The threefold calling of the Awen — the divine inspiration at the heart of Druidic practice. Three breaths, the sound opening into the sacred creative current that moves through all life.	The Druids Deep Dive

DOGON (Mali, West Africa)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Sigi Ceremony	Held every 60 years when Sirius (Sigi Tolo) returns to its specific position — a multi-year ceremonial cycle involving the construction of a new Great Mask, the transmission of sacred Sigi language, and the renewal of the entire community's relationship with the Nommo.	Dogon Beliefs Deep Dive
Dama Ceremony	Multi-day ceremony following death — the masquerades that guide the soul of the deceased from the world of the living to the world of the ancestors. The Kanaga mask's specific movements carry the soul upward.	Dogon Beliefs Deep Dive
Bado (Altar Making)	The construction and maintenance of specific altars to the Binu (sacred totemic beings) and ancestors — the material form of the ongoing relationship between the living and the spirit world.	Dogon Beliefs Deep Dive

EGYPTIAN (Ancient / Kemet)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Haligric Egyptian Burial Sequence	The complete Haligric burial practice: (1) cast/mold of the deceased made; (2) blood carried to running water; (3) six organs placed in directional resin vessels at cardinal and cross-cardinal points; (4) heart and brain preserved together inside the cast; (5) cremation; (6) ash poured into mold; (7) name inscribed; (8) pyramid gravesite with Watcher vessels placed at cardinal directions.	Haligric Rituals Book
Akhet / Opening of the Mouth	The sacred ceremony animating a statue or mummy — the specific ritual through which the divine being's ka (life force) is invited to inhabit the physical form. Prerequisite for all temple worship and burial.	Wisdom of Kemet Deep Dive
Priestly Daily Purification	Twice-daily cold water bathing, full body shaving, white linen dress — the sacred prerequisite for approaching the divine in the temple. Purity as the threshold of the sacred.	Sacred Body Health PDF; Wisdom of Kemet Deep Dive

ESTONIAN (Maausk / Earth Belief)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Hiis Ceremony	Ceremony at the sacred grove (hiis) — approach with specific greeting and permission, acknowledgment of the grove's inhabiting spirits, offering and prayer in the specific manner of the Maausk tradition.	Finnish/Karelian/Estonian Deep Dive

FINNISH / KARELIAN

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Runosinging Ceremony	Two singers facing each other holding hands, swaying in the trochaic meter, alternating call-and-response performance of the Kalevala songs. The ceremony of sacred knowledge transmission through song.	Finnish/Karelian/Estonian Deep Dive

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Tietäjä Healing Ceremony	The Finnish shaman-singer recites specific origin charms (syntyloitsut) — singing the origin story of the wound, illness, or affliction to rob it of its power. Knowing how something began is knowing how to end it.	Finnish/Karelian/Estonian Deep Dive
Sauna as Sacred Ceremony	The saunatonntu acknowledged, the kiuas (sacred stones) prepared, the löyly (sacred steam) raised — the sauna as the most sacred domestic space in Finnish tradition. Births and deaths traditionally occurred in the sauna.	Finnish/Karelian/Estonian Deep Dive; Sacred Body Health PDF

GA (Coastal Ghana)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Homowo Festival	The most important Ga annual ceremony — the drumming ban weeks before, families returning to the family house, the communal cooking of palm nut soup and kpokpoi (the sacred food), pouring libation to ancestors, and communal feasting. "Homowo" means "hooting at hunger" — a triumph feast.	Ga People Deep Dive
Ga Funeral — Wake	All-night gathering with highlife music and specific songs of the deceased's favorites, storytelling of specific memories, communal vigil through the darkness until rise of the day.	Ga People Deep Dive
Ga Funeral — Burial Day	The fantasy coffin procession, the Wulomo priest's ceremony, the burial with specific prayers to ancestors and the Ga deity Nai, the post-burial feast.	Ga People Deep Dive
Fantasy Coffin Selection	The family process of selecting the coffin shape that best represents the deceased's specific life — a canoe for a fisherman, a fish, a car, a cocoa pod. The community witnessing the story of the life through the form of its container.	Ga People Deep Dive

GREEK MYSTERIES

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Eleusinian Mysteries	The initiatory rites at Eleusis honoring Demeter and Persephone — the Lesser Mysteries (spring purification) and the Greater Mysteries (autumn initiation). The most widely attended mystery initiation in the ancient world. What was revealed inside is still unknown.	Greek Mysteries & Hermeticism Deep Dive
Orphic Initiatory Descent	The structured Orphic initiatory narrative of descent to the underworld, navigation of its waters, and return with the specific knowledge needed to break the wheel of incarnation.	Greek Mysteries & Hermeticism Deep Dive
Ritual Bathing Before Initiation	Sacred prerequisite for all Greek mystery initiations — the specific purification bath before crossing the sacred threshold into the mystery.	Greek Mysteries & Hermeticism Deep Dive

GUARANÍ (Paraguay / Brazil / Argentina)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Karai Ceremony	The sacred prophet-leader's ceremony — sacred tobacco, maracá calling patterns, the revelation spoken in ñe'ẽ porã (beautiful speech) that guides the community toward the Land Without Evil.	Guaraní Deep Dive
Jeroky (Sacred Dance)	The most important daily/regular Guaraní ceremony — gathering in the opy (sacred house), sacred tobacco offered, the jeroky dance connecting the community to the sacred through movement and chant.	Guaraní Deep Dive
Sacred Tobacco Ceremony	Petỹgua (sacred tobacco, distinct from commercial tobacco) prepared and shared in sacred pipe — the six-directional offering, the prayer through the smoke to the guardian spirits.	Guaraní Deep Dive

HAUDENOSAUNEE / IROQUOIS CONFEDERACY

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Thanksgiving Address (Ohén:ton Karihwatéhkwen)	The words that come before all else — spoken before every meeting, every ceremony, every school day in traditional Haudenosaunee practice. The acknowledgment of every element of the natural world, in specific order, from the earth to the Creator.	Haudenosaunee Deep Dive; Haligric Rituals Book

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Midwinter Ceremony	The most important Haudenosaunee ceremony — a multi-day ceremony of renewal, healing, thanksgiving, and the stirring of the new year's sacred fire. Dream sharing and fulfillment central to this ceremony.	Haudenosaunee Deep Dive
Green Corn Ceremony	Thanksgiving for the first corn — purification, community renewal, sacred dances, specific prayers of gratitude for the return of the corn.	Haudenosaunee Deep Dive
Condolence Ceremony	The specific ceremony of lifting grief from the grieving — the ceremonial technology that the Peacemaker demonstrated when the Haudenosaunee Confederacy was formed. Grief addressed as a physical obstruction requiring ceremonial removal.	Haudenosaunee Deep Dive

HAWAIIAN

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Lomilomi Massage Ceremony	Not merely physical massage — a ceremony of clearing old energy from the body. Practitioners pray through their hands; the body of the person receiving is treated as sacred ground.	Sacred Body Health PDF
La'au Lapa'au (Plant Medicine)	Traditional Hawaiian plant medicine ceremony — specific plants for specific conditions, the healer's prayer as inseparable from the plant's medicine.	Sacred Body Health PDF
Ho'oponopono	The Hawaiian practice of reconciliation and forgiveness — the four phrases (I'm sorry, Please forgive me, Thank you, I love you) spoken as a ceremony of clearing and restoration, directed inward as much as outward.	Polynesian Mythology Deep Dive

HOODOO (American Folk Magic)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Mojo Bag Construction	The construction of a sacred cloth bag for a specific purpose — petition paper written with encircling technique, specific roots, herbs, curios, and personal concerns layered together, the bag fed with whiskey or oil and named.	Hoodoo Deep Dive

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Candle Work	Candle selected by color for purpose, carved with name and desire, dressed with condition oil (toward = drawing, away = banishing), burned in specific configuration with petition paper.	Hoodoo Deep Dive
Spiritual Bath / Floor Wash	Herb tea prepared for specific intention (uncrossing, love, money, protection), applied head-downward for release or feet-upward for drawing, body air-dried after.	Hoodoo Deep Dive
Crossroads Work	Specific offerings, petitions, or objects left at the crossroads at specific times (midnight, specific lunar phases) — the crossroads as the meeting point of all paths and the residence of crossroads spirits.	Hoodoo Deep Dive

HOPI

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Kachina Ceremonies	The most important Hopi ceremonial tradition — masked dances in which the kachina spirits are called into the village. The dancers do not represent the kachinas; they become them.	Hopi Beliefs Deep Dive
Soyal (Winter Solstice)	The ceremony that opens the Kachina season — the Kachinas return to the village, the new year begins, the specific prayers for the year's unfolding are offered.	Hopi Beliefs Deep Dive
Niman (Home Dance)	The ceremony that closes the Kachina season — the Kachinas return to the San Francisco Peaks, carrying the community's prayers with them, leaving their gifts with the children.	Hopi Beliefs Deep Dive

IGBO (Odinani — Nigeria)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Aha Njoku (Yam Festival)	The most important Igbo agricultural ceremony — tapu on new yams before the festival, offering to ancestors and Ani (Earth deity), first eating releasing the tapu, communal celebration of the harvest.	Igbo Odinani Deep Dive

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Igbo Second Burial (Ikwa Ozu)	The ceremony that formally establishes the deceased as an ancestor — mmanwu appearance, music, ofo staff presented, the transition from the recently dead to the honored ancestral realm made permanent.	Igbo Odinani Deep Dive
Ozo Title Ceremony	The elaborate ceremony through which a man receives the Ozo title — one of the highest sacred and social honors in Igbo society, requiring specific initiatory stages.	Igbo Odinani Deep Dive
Afa Divination	The Afa diviner's ceremony — preparing the divination tools, entering the sacred state, reading the specific signatures of the Afa system to identify the spiritual situation and its remedy.	Igbo Odinani Deep Dive

INCA / TAWANTINSUYU

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Inti Raymi (Sun Festival)	The great annual festival honoring Inti (the Sun god) — conducted at the winter solstice in the Southern Hemisphere (June). The Sapa Inca offers the sacred fire. Still celebrated annually at Sacsayhuamán in Cusco, Peru.	Inca Tawantinsuyu Deep Dive
Capacocha	Sacred ceremony involving specific offerings to the mountain apus — the most important of which are made at the high mountain shrines. The mountain itself as a living sacred being who receives and responds to ceremony.	Inca Tawantinsuyu Deep Dive

ISLAMIC TRADITION

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Wudu (Ablution)	Performed before each of the five daily prayers — washing hands, mouth, nose, face, arms, head, ears, feet in specific sequence. The body brought to sacred readiness.	Islam Deep Dive; Sacred Body Health PDF
Ghusl (Full Body Bath)	Required after specific states — complete body washing restoring ritual purity. Sacred bodily renewal.	Islam Deep Dive

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Salah (Five Daily Prayers)	The primary Islamic sacred practice — conducted at dawn, midday, afternoon, sunset, and night, preceded by wudu, the body oriented toward the Kaaba in Mecca.	Islam Deep Dive
Hajj (Pilgrimage)	The annual pilgrimage to Mecca — one of the Five Pillars. The Tawaf (circumambulation of the Kaaba seven times counter-clockwise), the walk between Safa and Marwa, the standing at Arafat.	Islam Deep Dive

JAPANESE (Shinto)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Misogi Purification	Standing under cold waterfalls or immersing in cold rivers — clearing the energetic field (ke), not merely cleaning the body. The most fundamental Shinto purification practice.	Shinto Deep Dive; Sacred Body Health PDF
Matsuri (Shrine Festival)	The specific ceremonies conducted at Shinto shrines honoring the kami — including the procession of the mikoshi (portable shrine), the sacred dances, the specific offerings.	Shinto Deep Dive
Kagura (Sacred Dance)	Sacred dance performed at shrines to honor the kami and maintain the sacred relationship between the human and divine communities.	Shinto Deep Dive
Shinrin-Yoku (Forest Bathing)	The practice of spending time in the forest in specific open sensory awareness — validated by research to reduce cortisol, lower blood pressure, and restore nervous system regulation. Sacred body care through the medicine of trees.	Sacred Body Health PDF

KOREAN MUISM

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Naerimsut (Mudang Initiation)	The ceremony through which the sinbyeong calling is formally accepted, the mudang's primary working spirits identified, and the sacred role formally established. After often years of debilitating spirit illness.	Korean Muism Deep Dive

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Gut (Shamanic Ceremony)	The full Korean shamanic ceremony — twelve specific segments, each honoring different spirit categories. The mudang becomes the vehicle through which the spirits speak, heal, and resolve unfinished business.	Korean Muism Deep Dive
Jinogi Gut (Death Ceremony)	The specific Gut ceremony for the recently deceased — helping the soul transition and communicating between the dead and the living family to resolve any unfinished matters.	Korean Muism Deep Dive
Byeongsi Gut (Healing Ceremony)	The specific Gut ceremony for healing illness — the mudang identifying the spiritual cause and addressing it through spirit negotiation, offering, and ceremonial resolution.	Korean Muism Deep Dive

LAKOTA / SIOUX

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Inipi (Sweat Lodge)	The purification ceremony — the sacred structure as Earth Mother's womb, entry on hands and knees, the hot stones (Grandfathers) honored, steam raised, prayers offered in the darkness, emergence as rebirth.	Lakota Sioux Deep Dive; Sacred Body Health PDF
Hanbleceya (Vision Quest)	The ceremony of seeking vision — four days and nights alone in a sacred location without food or water, calling to the spirits for guidance, purpose, and sacred direction.	Lakota Sioux Deep Dive
Sun Dance (Wiwanyag Wachipi)	The most important Lakota ceremony — multi-day ceremony of prayer, fasting, sacred dance, and sometimes physical piercing as a commitment of the body to the sacred.	Lakota Sioux Deep Dive
Keeping of the Soul	The specific ceremony for maintaining the soul's presence in the community after death — keeping a bundle containing the deceased's hair, honoring it until its formal release.	Lakota Sioux Deep Dive

LITHUANIAN SACRED TRADITION

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Vaidilut Sacred Fire Ceremony	The maintenance of the eternal sacred fire at Romuva — daily tending by the vaidilut, the Krivis's major ceremonies conducted around the perpetual flame. The fire's continuity as the continuity of the sacred.	Lithuanian Sacred Traditions Deep Dive
Sacred Oak Grove Ceremony	Ceremony at the sacred oak grove — the specific sacred site of Perkūnas's primary residence, with prayers to thunder, lightning, and sacred justice.	Lithuanian Sacred Traditions Deep Dive
Užgavėnės (Winter Driving-Away)	The Morė effigy constructed, the ritual battle between winter and spring, the burning of the Morė, the noisy driving-away of winter through communal cacophony.	Lithuanian Sacred Traditions Deep Dive
Joninės/Rasos (Midsummer)	Hilltop bonfires, fire-jumping, pre-dawn sacred dew collection, rue wreaths floated on water for divination, the search for the sacred fern flower.	Lithuanian Sacred Traditions Deep Dive
Vėlinės (Festival of the Dead)	The Lithuanian ancestor festival — honoring the dead, tending graves, and maintaining the relationship between the living and the ancestors. Occurring at the same time as Samhain in the sacred calendar.	Lithuanian Sacred Traditions Deep Dive

MŪORI (Aotearoa / New Zealand)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Pūwhiri (Welcome Ceremony)	The formal welcoming of visitors (manuhiri) by the host people — the karanga (women's call opening the sacred exchange), the haka, the hongi (pressing of noses, sharing of breath/life force), the formal speeches.	MŪori Deep Dive
Haka	Sacred ceremony combining chant, physical movement, and collective mana synchronization — five types including the war haka (peruperu), the welcome haka, and the funeral haka. Each word carries specific sacred meaning.	MŪori Deep Dive
Tangihanga (Funeral)	The MŪori funeral — the tūpāpaku remains with the community on the marae for multiple days, continuous waiata (songs), the final farewell speeches, the burial with specific karakia.	MŪori Deep Dive

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Karakia	Sacred prayer — the specific Māori form of opening space, acknowledging the atua, and framing ceremony. Karakia opens and closes all significant activities in traditional Māori life.	Māori Deep Dive

MANDAEAN

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Masbuta (Baptism)	Full-body immersion in flowing (living) water — conducted repeatedly throughout life, not once as initiation. The Mandaeans are the only ancient religion that requires flowing water; still water is insufficient. The Jordan River as sacred archetype.	Mandaeism Deep Dive
Masiqta (Ascent Mass)	The ceremony for the recently dead — specific sacred foods prepared, prayers naming the deceased, the ascent of the soul assisted through ceremonial action.	Mandaeism Deep Dive
Kanshay Zahla (Sacred New Year)	The Mandaean sacred New Year festival — the primary annual community ceremony, involving specific ceremonial foods, prayers, and renewal of sacred commitments.	Mandaeism Deep Dive

MAPUCHE (Chile / Argentina)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Machi Initiation	The ceremony through which a machi is formally recognized — the pewma (dream) calling, preparation period, the rewe pole erected, the kultrun drum made, the formal recognition ceremony.	Mapuche Deep Dive
Machitún (Healing Ceremony)	The machi's healing ceremony — opening tayül songs, kultrun healing rhythms, the küymi trance, spirit world navigation, the identification and extraction of the spiritual source of illness.	Mapuche Deep Dive
Ngillatun (Great Community Ceremony)	Multi-day community ceremony honoring Ngenechen — east-facing orientation, the machi's opening, the Ngeilipun prayers, the Purún sacred dance, the communal feasting.	Mapuche Deep Dive

MELANESIAN TRADITIONS

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Mok Ceremony / Pig Kill (PNG Highlands)	Years-in-preparation pig exchange ceremony — the display, formal speeches, the killing, the distribution (publicly tracked to establish or repay social obligations). Sacred economics as ceremony.	Melanesian Traditions Deep Dive
Naghol (Land Diving, Vanuatu)	Men dive headfirst from towers 20–30 meters high, stopped by ankle-tied vines, head grazing the earth — a harvest ceremony ensuring the yam crop's abundance through the ultimate commitment of the body.	Melanesian Traditions Deep Dive
Kava Ceremony (Fiji / Vanuatu)	Ceremonial preparation and consumption of yaqona (kava) in specific order by rank — the primary social, political, and sacred gathering protocol of many Pacific Island cultures.	Melanesian Traditions Deep Dive
Sing-Sing (PNG)	Sacred community gathering and ceremonial exchange — specific sacred dances, specific ceremonial dress, the meeting of different clans in the sacred space of shared ceremony.	Melanesian Traditions Deep Dive
Gawai Festival (Dayak, Borneo)	Harvest festival — longhouse cleansing, the miring offering ceremony, the ngajat dance in full traditional regalia, the sacred tuak (rice wine) sharing.	Melanesian Traditions Deep Dive

NAVAJO / DINÉ

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Blessingway	The most important Navajo ceremony — a ceremony of restoration to hózhó (beauty, harmony, balance). Conducted for specific life transitions: pregnancy, before military service, after illness, at any moment of realignment.	Navajo Diné Deep Dive
Night Chant (Yeibichai)	A nine-night healing ceremony — one of the most elaborate ceremonial structures in any tradition. Specific masked dancers, specific sand paintings created and erased, specific chants for each of the nine nights.	Navajo Diné Deep Dive

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Sand Painting Ceremony	Sacred sand paintings created for specific healing ceremonies — created, used ceremonially to transmit healing, then erased. The painting as a temporary living sacred space, not a permanent art object.	Navajo Diné Deep Dive

NORSE / NORDIC

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Blót (Blood Sacrifice)	Seasonal sacrifice ceremony — conducted at the major Nordic festivals (Yule, Dísablót, Sigrblót, Dísir), involving the sacred animal, the blessing of the meat and the mead, the sprinkling of the altar and community.	Norse Runes & Pagan/Wiccan Deep Dive
Seidr (Trance Magic)	The Norse form of trance-based magical practice — the practitioner enters a specific altered state to journey between the realms and access prophetic knowledge or effect change in the web of wyrd.	Norse Runes & Pagan/Wiccan Deep Dive
Rune Casting	Divination and magical practice using the Elder Futhark runic alphabet — each rune a sacred symbol with specific cosmological meaning, cast or drawn to read the current moment's sacred signature.	Norse Runes & Pagan/Wiccan Deep Dive

OJIBWE / ANISHINAABE

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Midewiwin Initiation	Grand Medicine Society initiation — sweat lodge, procession to the Mide Lodge, sacred teachings for the specific degree, the mide cowrie shell as the vehicle of sacred power.	Ojibwe Anishinaabe Deep Dive
Vision Quest	Extended solitary period of fasting and prayer seeking sacred vision and direction — the specific protocol of the Anishinaabe tradition, supported by a medicine person's oversight.	Ojibwe Anishinaabe Deep Dive
Drum Ceremony	The sacred drum as a living being — its specific protocols, the ceremony of its construction and feeding, the communal drum ceremony as the heartbeat of the community.	Ojibwe Anishinaabe Deep Dive

PHILIPPINE INDIGENOUS

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Pagdiwata (Palawan)	The most important healing ceremony of the Palawan people — the balian (spirit medium) enters trance to communicate with the diwata spirits and address the spiritual source of illness.	Philippine Indigenous Deep Dive
Kadangyan Feast	The sacred feast ceremony of high-status families — establishing and maintaining sacred relationships through the specific protocol of communal eating, offering, and acknowledgment of the spirits.	Philippine Indigenous Deep Dive

POLYNESIAN / PACIFIC GENERAL

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Kava Ceremony (various Pacific)	See: Melanesian Traditions — Kava Ceremony (Fiji). Also practiced in Tonga, Samoa, Vanuatu, and across the Pacific as the primary ceremony of sacred gathering and social order.	Melanesian Traditions Deep Dive; Polynesian Mythology Deep Dive
Hula (Hawaiian)	Sacred dance tradition — a ceremony of prayer, genealogical recitation, and the specific embodiment of the natural world through movement. Not entertainment; a ceremony of transmission.	Polynesian Mythology Deep Dive

ROMAN RELIGION (Pre-Christian)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Birthday Ceremony (Natalis)	Annual celebration of the person's genius (or juno for women) — garland, incense at the lararium, unmixed wine offered, specific prayers to the protective spirit that accompanied the person from birth.	Roman Religion Deep Dive
Lararium Ceremony (Daily)	Daily household shrine ceremony — incense, garland renewal, prayer to the Lares, meal portion offered to the household gods. The sacred rhythm of domestic life.	Roman Religion Deep Dive

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Vestalia (June 7–15)	The festival of Vesta — the penus vestae opened to women, the barefoot procession with food offerings, the sacred fire at its most publicly honored. The sacred feminine at the center of Roman civic life.	Roman Religion Deep Dive
Augury	Reading the sacred will of the gods through the templum (sacred space marked in sky and ground), observation of bird flight and behavior — the sacred technology of decision-making.	Roman Religion Deep Dive
Parentalia (Feb 13–21)	Festival of the sacred dead — family procession to the tomb, offerings poured through the specus (tomb hole), the public celebration of the ancestors.	Roman Religion Deep Dive
Saturnalia	The great reversal festival (December) — slaves and masters exchange roles, gifts given, the sacred inversion acknowledging that all social order is a temporary arrangement within the larger cosmic order.	Roman Religion Deep Dive
Lupercalia	The February fertility festival — sacred running of the Luperci priests through Rome, specific ceremonial striking of women with goatskin strips for fertility. One of the oldest Roman sacred practices.	Roman Religion Deep Dive

SAN / BUSHMEN (Southern Africa)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Trance Dance	The most important San ceremony — the community gathers in a circle, women clap and sing the sacred n/om songs, the healers enter trance, their n/om (spiritual energy) boils up the spine, they enter the spirit world to heal and protect the community. The oldest documented healing practice on earth.	San Bushmen Deep Dive

SENUFO / PORO (Côte d'Ivoire / Mali / Burkina Faso)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Poro Initiation	The most important sacred structure in Senufo society — a multi-year initiatory cycle conducted in the sacred forest, transmitting the sacred knowledge that organizes Senufo spiritual, social, and political life.	Senufo Poro Deep Dive
Sandogo Divination Ceremony	The Sandogo society's divination system — identifying sacred ordinances (sanadi) that regulate the individual's relationship with the sacred.	Senufo Poro Deep Dive

SLAVIC PAGANISM

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Marzanna Ceremony (Winter Drowning)	The Mor■/Marzanna effigy constructed, processed through the village with taunting songs, then drowned or burned — the formal ceremonial expulsion of winter and death.	Slavic Paganism Deep Dive
Kupala Night (Ivan Kupala)	June 23–24 midsummer — bonfires lit, couples jump the fire (purification and love divination), flower crowns made and floated on water, the search for the sacred fern flower that reveals hidden treasure.	Slavic Paganism Deep Dive
Rusalia Festival	The festival honoring the Rusalki (water spirits) — specific offerings to the water, specific ceremonial forms acknowledging the feminine water spirits.	Slavic Paganism Deep Dive
Domovoi Ceremony (New Home)	Cat enters first, bread and salt brought in, old home's domovoi formally invited to accompany the family, first fire lit and acknowledged — the ceremony of establishing sacred relationship with a new home.	Slavic Paganism Deep Dive

SOUTHEAST ASIAN INDIGENOUS

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Shaman Initiation (Various)	The pattern across Southeast Asian indigenous traditions: the spirit illness calling, the training under an established shaman, the public ceremony of recognition, the primary spirit companion identified. Documented in Hmong, Karen, Dayak, and other traditions.	Southeast Asian Indigenous Deep Dive
Rice Soul Ceremony	The ceremony acknowledging the rice plant's soul (khwan in Thai, semangat in Malay) — harvesting with specific protocols so the rice soul remains with the grain, carrying its sacred vitality.	Southeast Asian Indigenous Deep Dive

SUFI (Islamic Mysticism)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Dhikr (Remembrance of God)	The primary Sufi ceremony — the rhythmic repetition of specific divine names or sacred phrases, accompanied by specific breath patterns and sometimes movement, until the practitioner merges with the Name.	Sufism Deep Dive
Sama (Whirling / Sacred Music)	The Mevlevi Order's specific sacred ceremony — the whirling dance (Sema) as a ceremony of divine union, the music as the vehicle of divine presence, the white robes as the shroud of ego.	Sufism Deep Dive

TENGRISM (Central Asian / Mongolian)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Bö Ceremony	The Mongolian shaman's ceremony — fire preparation acknowledging Etugen (Earth Mother), opening prayers to Tengri (Sky Father), drumming journey between the realms, healing or divination.	Tengrism Deep Dive
Tailagan (Sky Ceremony)	Seasonal community ceremony honoring Tengri — the Krivis-equivalent leading the procession, white animal offered, the community's relationship with sky and earth renewed.	Tengrism Deep Dive
Fire Ceremony (Gal Eej)	Ceremony honoring the Fire Mother (Gal Eej) — specific offerings to the fire, the prohibitions (never step over a fire, never point your feet toward it), the fire as living sacred being.	Tengrism Deep Dive

THEOSOPHY

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Triangle Meditation	Three practitioners connected in visualized triangle of light, reciting the Great Invocation, radiating light outward — the Theosophical ceremonial contribution to the Haligric group practice framework.	Theosophy Deep Dive

VODOU (Haitian)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Voodoo Ceremony (Fèt)	The Vodou ceremony — the vèvè drawn in cornmeal calling specific Lwa, the drums beginning (each Lwa has a specific rhythm), the Lwa possessing initiated practitioners, the healing, divination, and sacred business conducted through those sacred vessels.	Vodou Haiti Deep Dive
Dessounin (Soul Separation)	The ceremony conducted after death to separate the gros bon ange (the universal soul) from the ti bon ange (the individual soul) — allowing the individual essence to begin its transition properly.	Vodou Haiti Deep Dive

WICCAN / PAGAN (Contemporary)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Wheel of the Year — All Eight	See: Druidic/Celtic — Wheel of the Year. The same eight ceremonies with specific Wiccan ceremonial forms: the casting of the circle, calling the quarters, Drawing Down the Moon or Sun, working, cakes and ale, circle closing.	Norse Runes & Pagan/Wiccan Deep Dive
Drawing Down the Moon	The ceremony in which the High Priestess invokes the Goddess into herself — becoming the vessel through which the divine feminine speaks directly to the gathered community.	Norse Runes & Pagan/Wiccan Deep Dive
Casting the Circle	The specific ceremony of creating sacred space — the circle cast with the athame (ritual blade), the four directional powers called, the space between the worlds established.	Norse Runes & Pagan/Wiccan Deep Dive

YAZIDI

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Lalish Pilgrimage (Cemaya Lalish)	The annual assembly at the sacred valley — shoes removed at the entrance (entire valley is sacred ground), the specific sites visited in sequence, the sacred spring water used for baptism and blessing.	Yazidism Deep Dive
Baptism Ceremony	Conducted at Lalish with the sacred spring water — the specific immersion protocols, the Qawwal's presence, the sacred thread tied as the mark of initiation.	Yazidism Deep Dive
Sacred Fire Ceremony	The maintenance and ceremony of the eternal sacred flame — the Yazidi's primary living connection to the divine. Fire is never extinguished; it is the continuous presence of Tawûsî Melek.	Yazidism Deep Dive
Qawwal Ceremony	The sacred music ceremony conducted by the hereditary Qawwal musicians — the davul drum, the sorna oboe, the specific sacred songs that invoke the heft sirr (seven mysteries).	Yazidism Deep Dive
Wednesday Sacred Practice	The Yazidi weekly sacred day — specific prayers and ceremonies conducted every Wednesday. The Yazidi Sabbath.	Yazidism Deep Dive

YORUBA (Nigeria / West Africa)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Egungun Ceremony	The Ancestor Masquerade — the egungun costume through which the collective ancestral force is made visible in the community. The ancestors walk among the living. The costume must not be touched; it is the ancestor's body.	Yoruba Deep Dive
Orisha Festival	Each Orisha has specific annual festival days — celebrated with specific ceremonies, specific foods, specific colors, specific rhythms. The festival as the living relationship between the Orisha and their devotees.	Yoruba Deep Dive
Divination (Ifá)	The babalawo's divination ceremony using the 256 Odù of the Ifá corpus — the most sophisticated divination system in the world, consulted for all major life decisions.	Yoruba Deep Dive

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Sacred Bath (Ebó Olomi)	The Yoruba sacred bath — herb selection by Orisha association and intention, the prayer before application, the specific protocols for drawing versus releasing.	Yoruba Deep Dive; Sacred Body Health PDF

ZAOULI (Guro People, Côte d'Ivoire)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Zaouli Sacred Dance Ceremony	The most elaborate sacred masquerade ceremony in the Guro tradition — preliminary divination, dancer's purification, the donning of the Zaouli mask (a face within a face), the specific footwork sequence, the mask's removal requiring specific protocol. The fastest and most technically demanding masquerade in West Africa.	Zaouli Guro Sacred Mask Dance Deep Dive

ZULU / BANTU (Southern Africa)

CEREMONY / RITUAL	PURPOSE	SOURCE DOCUMENT
Umhlanga (Reed Dance)	The annual ceremony of young women — a ceremony of purity, community identity, and sacred feminine power. Young women gather reeds and carry them to the royal homestead as an offering and demonstration of communal solidarity.	Zulu Bantu Traditions Deep Dive
Ancestor Communication Ceremonies	Various ceremonies for consulting the izinyanya (ancestors) — the diviner (sangoma) as intermediary between the living and the ancestral realm, the specific protocols for opening communication.	Zulu Bantu Traditions Deep Dive

This index is a living document. As the Haligrlicity library continues to expand, each new deep dive PDF adds to this ceremony index. The full step-by-step instructions for every ceremony named here live in the source document cited in the rightmost column. This index is the map. The deep dive PDFs are the territory. Ahshee.